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Senior Developer

Driver and Vehicle Standards Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 26th July 2026



Driver & Vehicle
Standards
Agency

Reference number

470376

Salary

£44,241

Plus an additional Government Digital & Data Allowance of up to £14,756. Candidates based in Yeading will also receive the London Weighting allowance of £4,000.

A Civil Service Pension with an employer contribution of 28.97%

Job grade

Senior Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

Digital and Data

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology
Quality

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

2

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Location

Bristol, Swansea, Leeds, Nottingham, Newcastle, Oldham (Chadderton), Birmingham (Garretts Green), or Uxbridge.

This role is being advertised in Uxbridge, however the contractual base will be Yeading. While estates work is being carried out in Yeading all posts are being temporarily based at Uxbridge.

Successful applicants will start with us at our Uxbridge location. However, everyone will be required to work from Yeading when it reopens in 2028.

You will receive the London Weighting allowance of £4,000 while based at Uxbridge and this will continue when we move to Yeading.

About the job

Job summary

Join DVSA's mission to make roads safer and more efficient by shaping the future of digital public services. As a Senior Developer, you'll play a pivotal role in designing, building, and evolving high-impact digital platforms and services that serve millions across the UK.

This will be a key role in the design, build, support, implementation and improvement of digital services, products, and platforms across DVSA. You will work within a multi-disciplinary team using Agile delivery methodologies, delivering solutions that meet user needs.

You will be committed to quality and will promote quality software engineering techniques within the team, such as code review, design review, reusability of code, refactoring, automated testing, and use of standards.

Joining our department comes with many benefits, including:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [here](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave), plus 8 bank holidays a privilege day for the King's birthday

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Read more in the Benefits section below!

Find out more about what it's like working at [Driver and Vehicle Standards Agency - Department for Transport Careers](#)

Job description

You will be expected to work from requirements or high-level design without the need for direct supervision and will be responsible for the development and delivery of well-designed and executed software and data management solutions, using Agile methodologies. You will coach, support and mentor individual and Junior/Apprentice developers.

Your responsibilities will include, but aren't limited to:

Building digital services and software solutions to serve a variety of user's needs and complying with the Digital by Default service standard.

Implementing APIs for internal and external use

Developing solutions that put the user and user experience first.

Fostering continuous improvement of services through identification and implementation of strategic end to end system improvements.

Demonstrate leadership by providing influence, direction, and guidance to Developers, Junior/Apprentice Developers to support the delivery of objectives.

For further information on the role, please read the attached role profile. Please note that the role profile is for information purposes only - whilst all elements are relevant to the role, they may not all be assessed during the recruitment process. This job advert will detail exactly what will be assessed during the recruitment process.

Person specification

We are looking for someone who has:

A proven track record in successful agile development of digital services.

Proficiency in front-end and/or back-end development, with expertise in PHP, TypeScript or JavaScript.

Experience coaching developers within Agile frameworks, ensuring quality and timely delivery.

Quick adoption of new programming tools, sharing knowledge with peers and juniors.

Strong grasp of software design principles and systematic problem-solving skills.

Effective negotiation and communication with senior stakeholders on technical matters.

Experience in diagnosing production issues, utilising testing for solution validation, and basic understanding of web security.

Additional Information

Government Digital and Data Allowance

The role is part of the Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession and utilises an enhanced Capability Based Pay Framework which provides access to a Digital and Data allowance.

The base pay is £44,241. In addition to this the role includes a Digital and Data allowance of up to £14,756.

The value of allowance awarded will be based on an assessment of your skills and experience as demonstrated through the selection process. Here are more details on the pay framework.

Working hours, office attendance and travel requirements

Full time roles consist of 37 hours per week.

Whilst we welcome applications from those looking to work with us on a part time basis, there is a business requirement for the successful candidate to be able to work at least **30** hours per week.

Occasional travel to other offices will be required, which may involve overnight stays.

This role **is suitable** for hybrid working, which is a non-contractual arrangement where a combination of workplace and home-based working can be accommodated subject to business requirements.

The expectation at present is a minimum of **60%** of your working time a month will be spent at either your designated workplace (one of the locations cited in the advert) or, when required for business reasons, in another office/ work location. There may be occasions where you are required to attend above the minimum expectation.

If you have a question about hybrid working, part time/job share hours, flexible working, travelling for work, or require a reasonable adjustment, please contact the Vacancy Holder during the recruitment process to avoid possible disappointment later in the process should your working arrangements not be compatible with the requirements of the role (see below for contact details).

Please note that we do not hold a UK Visa & Immigration (UKVI) Skilled Worker Licence sponsor and are unable to sponsor any individuals for Skilled Worker Sponsorship. Candidates must ensure they have the appropriate rights to work in the UK before application.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Delivering at Pace

Developing Self and Others

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession - Information security - Level: practitioner.

Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession - Development process optimisation - Level: working.

Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession - Programming and build (software engineering) - Level: practitioner.

Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession - Modern development standards - Level: practitioner.

Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession - Systems design - Level: practitioner.

Government Digital and Data (or Government Security Profession Career Framework) profession - Systems integration - Level: practitioner.

Benefits

Alongside your salary of £44,241, Driver and Vehicle Standards Agency contributes £12,816 towards you being a member of the Civil Service Defined Benefit Pension scheme. [Find out what benefits a Civil Service Pension provides \(opens in a new window\).](#)

Being part of our brilliant Civil Service means you will have access to a wide range of fantastic benefits:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [here](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave).

8 Bank Holidays plus an additional Privilege Day to mark the King's birthday.

Access to the staff discount portal.

Excellent career development opportunities and the potential to undertake professional qualifications relevant to your role paid for by the department, such as CIPD, Prince2, apprenticeships, etc.

24-hour Employee Assistance Programme providing free confidential help and advice for staff.

Find out more about [the benefits of working at DfT and its agencies](#) (opens in a new window).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours and Technical skills.

Our selection process ensures a comprehensive assessment of each applicant's qualifications, skills, and potential fit within our organisation.

The selection process for this role will be:

Stage 1: Sift of CV & Personal Statement

Stage 2: Interview & Assessment

You must be successful at each stage to progress to the next stage.

Stage 1: Sift of CV & personal Statement

You will be asked to provide a CV (unlimited wordcount) and personal statement (750-word count). Please structure your Personal Statement to provide detailed evidence of each of the following:

- Proven track record in successful agile development of digital services.

- Proficiency in front-end and/or back-end development, with expertise in PHP, TypeScript or JavaScript.

- Effective negotiation and communication with senior stakeholders on technical matters.

The sift will take place week commencing 27th July 2026.

If successful at this stage, you will then be invited for interview & assessment.

Stage 2: Interview & Assessment

At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Behaviours:

- Delivering at Pace

- Developing Self and Others

Technical skills:

- Information security - Level: practitioner

Development process optimisation - Level: working

You will also be required to participate in a technical assessment and coding exercise at interview which will assess the following technical skills:

Programming and build (software engineering) - Level: practitioner

Modern development standards - Level: practitioner

Systems design - Level: practitioner

Systems integration - Level: practitioner

The interviews will take place week commencing 17th August 2026.

This interview will be conducted online via Microsoft Teams. Further details will be provided to you should you be selected for interview.

You can find out more about [our hiring process, how to apply, and application and interview guidance on our careers site \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Please note that we will try to meet the dates set out in the advert. There may be occasions when these dates will change.

Further information on the selection process

Feedback on your application can only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

We will also hold a 12 reserve list for this role, which may lead to potential opportunities beyond the role you applied for. You can read more about our reserve lists [here](#).

Should we receive a large number of applications, we may invite a shortlist of the highest performing candidates to interview. This means that some applications that meet the required standard could be placed on hold after the sift and invited to interview if the vacant position(s) remain unfilled. You will be notified if your application is being put on hold once the sift has been completed.

Appointments for this position will be made in order of merit. If you are successful in the selection process but there are no further available posts

for the advertised role, you may be contacted to discuss an offer for a lower graded role (with similar experience and responsibility requirements).

If you are unsuccessful in the selection process, your application may be considered for a lower graded position if your demonstrated skills and experience meet the requirements of the alternative position. Candidates will be considered in order of merit.

AI Tools and Platforms

Artificial Intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [AI Tools and Platforms](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use

If your application is successful but you have been dismissed from the Civil Service, your application could be removed at the pre-employment checking stage depending on the nature of the dismissal.

Applicants who are successful at interview will be, as part of pre-employment screening, subject to a check on the Internal Fraud Database (IFD). This check will provide information about employees who have been dismissed for fraud or dishonesty offences. This check also applies to employees who resign or otherwise leave before being dismissed for fraud or dishonesty had their employment continued. Any applicant's details held on the IFD will be refused employment. A candidate is not eligible to apply for a role within the Civil Service if the application is made within a 5-year period following a dismissal for carrying out internal fraud against government.

All external applicants and current employees of accredited non-departmental public bodies (NDPBs) will be required to undergo a Social Media Check. A Social Media Check is a review of your publicly available online activity, typically across platforms like LinkedIn, Facebook, X (formerly Twitter), Instagram, and others. The purpose is to identify any public posts or content that could raise concerns for employers, such as:

- Hate speech or discriminatory behaviour

- Threats or acts of violence

Illegal activity or substance misuse

Sexually explicit material

Extremist views or affiliations

Importantly, this check does not involve hacking into your accounts or accessing private messages. It only considers content you have chosen to make public. Employers use this kind of screening to help ensure their workplace remains safe, inclusive, and aligned with company values. It's not about judging your personality or lifestyle - it's about checking for potential red flags that might affect the role or company culture. If you have questions or concerns about the social media check, we would be happy to explain in more detail what's being looked at and how your data is handled securely and fairly.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a criminal record check.

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard \(opens in new window\)](#) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application

for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : DVSA Digital Recruitment Team

Email : Digitalrecruitment@dvsa.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : Digitalrecruitment@dvsa.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact Digitalrecruitment@dvsa.gov.uk. If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Click here (<https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/>) to visit Civil Service Commission.

